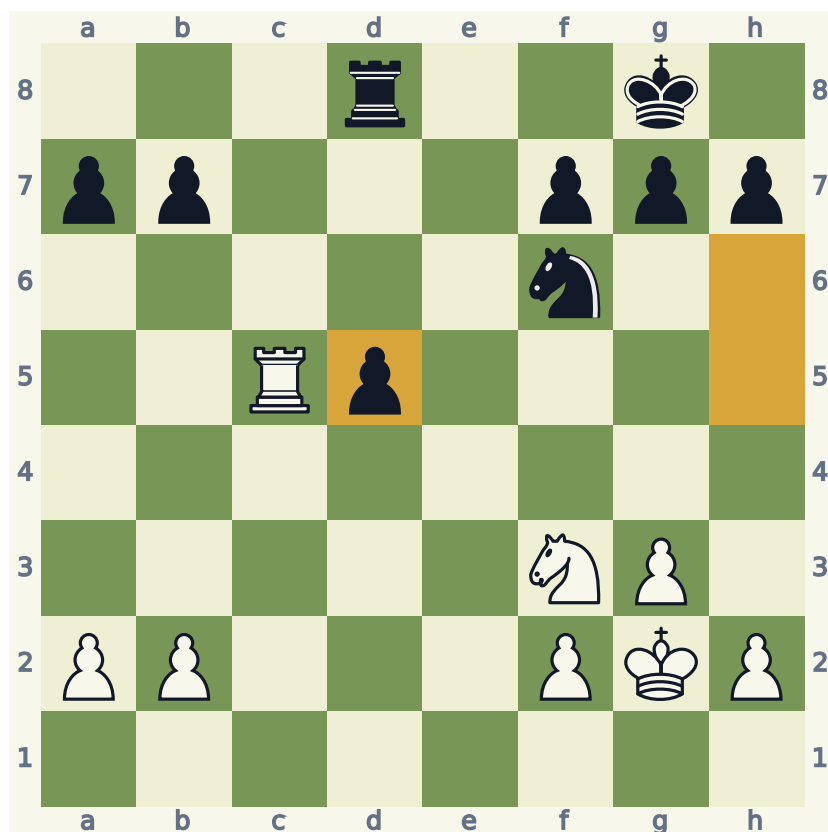


The principle of two weaknesses

Make the defense stretch across the board.

One weakness can often be defended without difficulty. Keep pressure on it while creating a second target far enough away that the same defenders cannot cover both efficiently. The stronger side needs safe routes for switching play; the defender seeks activity, exchanges or a way to eliminate one target.

MODEL A | WHITE TO MOVE



READ THE POSITION

- Rc5 attacks d5, defended by Rd8.
- White can expand on the kingside while keeping the rook active.
- A second target would make the defense less comfortable.

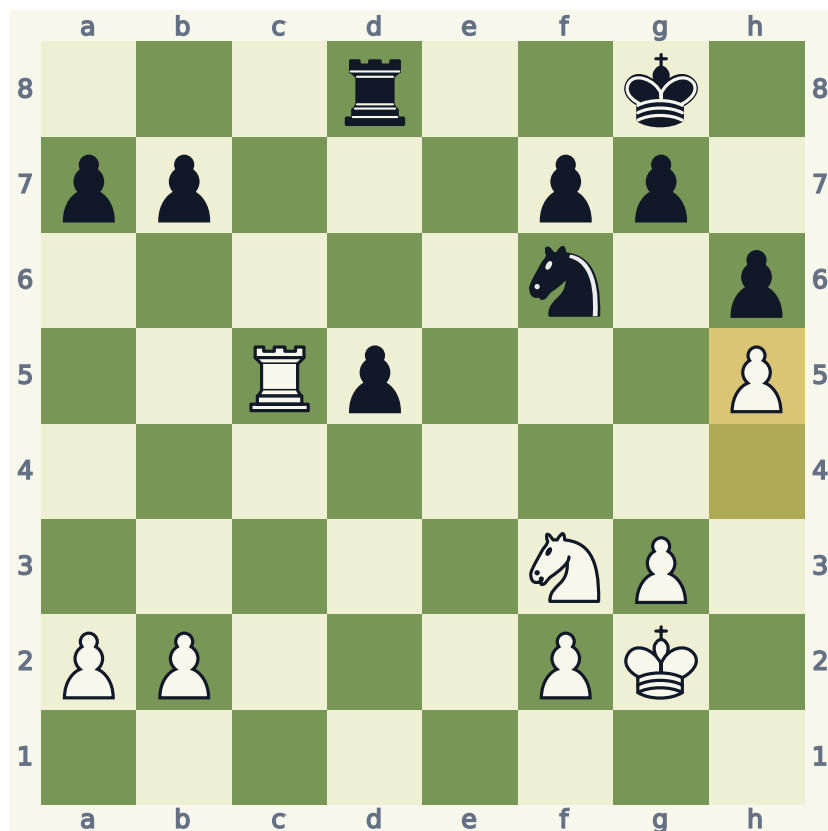
REMEMBER

- Keep pressure on the first target.
- Create the second where you can switch quickly.
- Do not let the defender free the first weakness.

Follow the logic

1. h4 h6 2. h5

MODEL A | POSITION AFTER THE LINE



h4

Prepare a kingside contact without abandoning pressure on d5. The first target keeps a black piece occupied.

...h6

Black fixes a pawn on a square that can be challenged. This is illustrative; Black should also consider active counterplay.

h5

White gains space and controls g6. A later g4-g5 may create contact, but that break still needs preparation and calculation.

THE OPPONENT'S PLAN

Black should avoid waiting for a second weakness to become fixed. Useful ideas include ...d4 if possible, active rook checks, a knight exchange or counterplay against White's queenside pawns.

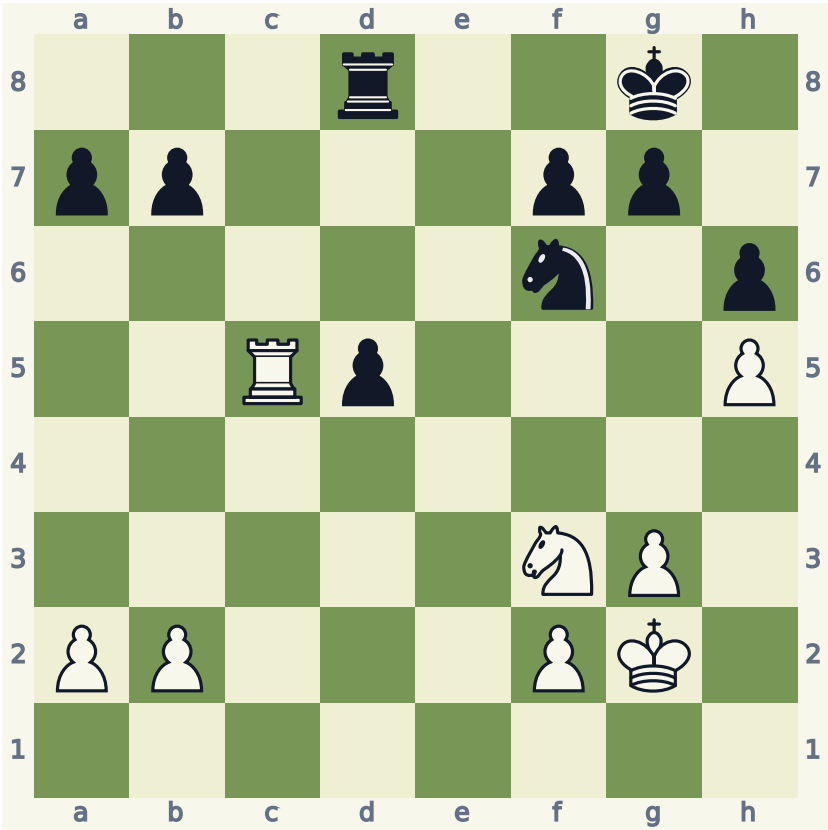
WHEN THE IDEA FAILS

Two weaknesses do not guarantee a win if your pieces cannot switch between them or your own king is exposed. Keep the position under control; creating a second front must not lose the first.

Find the plan

Set a timer for 6 minutes. Write the reasons, not just a move.

EXERCISE B | WHITE TO MOVE



- 1. What is White preparing with g4?
- 2. Which squares and pawns does the move stop defending?
- 3. Why is ...Ne4 a useful reminder for the attacker?

CHANGE ONE FEATURE

If ...d4 safely removed the original weakness, how would your plan change?

YOUR PLAN, THE OPPONENT'S REPLY, AND THE RESULTING POSITION

Position code (FEN): 3r2k1/pp3pp1/5n1p/2Rp3P/8/5NP1/PP3PK1/8 w - - 0 1

Answers and transfer

1. White prepares g5 to make contact with h6 or f6. The aim is to create a second target while Rc5 continues to pressure d5.
2. The g3-pawn no longer controls f4 and h4; g4 instead controls f5 and h5. King cover also changes. White must inspect these square changes before calling the pawn move an improvement.
3. Black uses the time to centralize the knight, supported by d5. It can attack f2 and create counterplay. White must calculate such activity while building the second front.

ONE ILLUSTRATIVE LEGAL LINE

1. g4 Ne4

Changed feature: Reevaluate immediately. You may no longer be stretching the defender between two targets, so the kingside expansion must be justified on its own.

APPLY IT TO YOUR GAMES

Choose a position where one pawn is securely defended. Find a second target and count the tempi each side needs to transfer its pieces.

Self-check: Award 0-2 points per numbered answer: 1 for the relevant fact, 1 for its consequence. Add 2 for the changed-feature answer. Revisit the lesson at 5/8 or below; repeat from memory tomorrow and one week later.

Related topics: 13, 18, 24. | Reference links and notation key: 00_Start_Here.pdf.